We should assume that anyone not overtly anti-Indian is for us and not the other way round. We have to be extremely subtle and delicate to the point of hypocrisy in attributing to Bangladeshi bureaucrats and politicians a virtue they may not possess. This is what Pakistanis are now doing. We should assume that the Bangla population continues to be grateful to us and would be with us if only their major economic ills are overcome.

While the Indians were discussing the country's future relationship with Bangladesh and the MEA was debating the kind of aid to be supplied to the Khondaker Mostaq Ahmad regime, on 3 November 1975, Mostaq was removed in yet another coup. This time, it was organised by the powerful Brigadier Khaled Mosharraf. There are various stories about Khaled's action but the one that had the most currency was that he had been pained by Mu-jib's death. Khaled put Ziaur Rahman under house arrest, but this coup resulted in another coup on the night of 6-7 November 1975.

An army unit led by Abu Taher overthrew Khaled and freed Ziaur Rahman. An interim government was formed and Chief Abu Sadat Mohammad Sayem became the chief martial law administrator while Zia was appointed his deputy.

N.F. Suntook, a joint secretary level intelligence officer who went on to become the R&AW chief in 1977, provided a ringside view of Bangladesh's situation. Suntook believed that there was a general emphasis on Islamic identity by the majority community fanned by the 'Islampasand' (Islam lovers) group of Muslim parties like the Muslim League and Council Muslim League. Suntook said that in the minds of the Bangladesh's populace, India had been linked with the regime of Sheikh